

Day 45 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Economic Trends in Tamil Nadu and Welfare Schemes

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's recent budget figures, welfare-scheme acronym traps, and several TN-specific welfare/development schemes — almost everything here is tied to a specific year and should be treated as a snapshot, not a permanent fact, since these figures and scheme names are revised often.

Q: Real exam: In the Tamil Nadu Budget Estimates 2022-23, what was the descending order of receipt amounts among State excise, Stamps & registration fees, and Motor vehicles tax?

A: Stamps and registration fees (highest), then State excise, then Motor vehicles tax (lowest) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: In the TN Budget Estimate 2022-23, what were the nominal GSDP growth, fiscal deficit, and outstanding debt figures (all confirmed TRUE together)?

A: Nominal GSDP growth: 14.0%. Fiscal deficit: 3.63% of GSDP. Outstanding debt: 27.76% of GSDP — all three confirmed true together by a real exam question (a historical snapshot specific to that budget year).

Q: Real exam: What are the REAL full forms of SCDC and NSFDC, and what's the common trap?

A: SCDC = Scheduled Castes Development Corporation (NOT 'South Asian Countries Development Corporation' — a real exam flagged this specific wrong expansion). NSFDC = National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NOT 'National Scheduled Castes FORTUNE Development Corporation' — also flagged as wrong). TRIFED (Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India) and LAMS (Large Area Multi-Purpose Societies) were both confirmed CORRECTLY paired in the same question.

Q: Real exam: Which statements about Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya, EMIS, and the Chief Minister's 'Nutritive Vegetable Garden Scheme' are TRUE?

A: TWO of four tested statements are true: the Nutritive Vegetable Garden Scheme is aimed towards housewives, AND it is meant for people living in urban areas. The OTHER two are false: Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya is NOT specifically described as being located 'in Chennai and Thoothukudi District' (that claim was marked false), and EMIS is NOT correctly described as 'the Grievance Redressal Mechanism for TN Government Employees' (also false) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: How many Coastal Districts of Tamil Nadu are involved in the TN-SHORE (Neithal Meethi Iyakkam) Project?

A: 14 — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Which TN welfare scheme years are correctly matched, and what's the trap?

A: Kalaigarnar Women's Rights Grant Scheme (2023) and Chief Minister's Thayumanavar Scheme (2025) are both correctly matched. The Chief Minister's Breakfast Scheme is NOT correctly matched to 2021 — a real exam confirmed this specific year-pairing as false (the scheme's actual launch year differs from 2021).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In the Tamil Nadu Budget Estimates 2022-23, which of these had the HIGHEST receipt amount?

- A. State excise
- B. Stamps and registration fees ✓**
- C. Motor vehicles tax
- D. All were equal

Explanation: Stamps and registration fees. [hard, question-bank-2022]

2. In the TN Budget Estimate 2022-23, the nominal GSDP growth was estimated at:

- A. 10.0%
- B. 12.0%
- C. 14.0% ✓**
- D. 16.0%

Explanation: 14.0%. [medium, question-bank-2022]

3. What is the REAL full form of SCDC?

- A. South Asian Countries Development Corporation
- B. Scheduled Castes Development Corporation ✓**

- C. State Cooperative Development Council
- D. Social Care and Development Commission

Explanation: Scheduled Castes Development Corporation. [hard, question-bank-2026]

4. What is the REAL full form of NSFDC?

- A. National Scheduled Castes Fortune Development Corporation
- B. National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation ✓**
- C. National Social Fund and Development Corporation
- D. National Scheduled Tribes Finance and Development Corporation

Explanation: National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation. [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. TRIFED stands for:

- A. Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India ✓**
- B. Tribal Industrial Federation of India
- C. Tribal Finance and Economic Development
- D. Tribal Resource Investment Federation

Explanation: Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India. [medium, question-bank-2026]

6. The Chief Minister's 'Nutritive Vegetable Garden Scheme' in Tamil Nadu is aimed at:

- A. Farmers in rural areas
- B. Housewives in urban areas ✓**
- C. Industrial workers
- D. School students

Explanation: Housewives in urban areas. [medium, question-bank-2026]

7. How many Coastal Districts of Tamil Nadu are involved in the TN-SHORE (Neithal Meethi Iyakkam) Project?

- A. 8
- B. 12
- C. 14 ✓**
- D. 20

Explanation: 14. [medium, question-bank-2026]

8. Which of the following TN welfare scheme-to-year pairings is INCORRECT?

- A. Kalaigarnar Women's Rights Grant Scheme — 2023
- B. Chief Minister's Thayumanavar Scheme — 2025
- C. Chief Minister's Breakfast Scheme — 2021 ✓**
- D. All three pairings are correct

Explanation: The Breakfast Scheme is NOT correctly paired with 2021. [hard, question-bank-2026]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "My Reminiscence" — Rabindranath Tagore

READING MATERIAL

A nostalgic extract from Tagore's memoir, describing his stay with his brother Jyotirindra at a riverside villa in Chandernagore after returning from his second trip to England — rich in descriptive imagery of the Ganges and the villa's stained-glass windows, but tinged with regret at the area's later industrial transformation.

Q: Who wrote "My Reminiscence", and where was the narrator's brother (Jyotirindra) living when the narrator returned home?

A: Rabindranath Tagore. His brother was living at Chandernagore (West Bengal), after the narrator's return from his second voyage to England.

Q: How does the narrator originally describe the Ganges, and what emotions does he experience by the riverside?

A: He describes the Ganges as cool and shaded along its wooded banks. By the riverside, he experiences a mix of JOY AND LONGING.

Q: What change had come over the riverside nests/area by the time of writing, and how does the narrator feel about this change?

A: The little riverside nests had been replaced by MILLS, which he describes as 'dragon-like' (belching smoke, making hissing noises, disturbing the earlier peaceful atmosphere). He feels PARTLY REGRETFUL about this modern industrial change, not entirely happy nor entirely indifferent.

Q: How were the rooms in the riverside villa arranged, and what was distinctive about the big sitting room's windows?

A: The rooms were arranged IRREGULARLY, on different levels (not on the same level, not in a straight line). The big sitting room had STAINED GLASS windows with colored pictures.

Q: What did the two stained-glass pictures in the sitting room depict, and what did they add to the room's atmosphere?

A: One depicted a swing in dense foliage; the other showed steps leading to a castle-like palace. Together, they added a sense of 'HOLIDAY MUSIC' to the room's atmosphere — a vivid, almost musical visual cheerfulness.

Q: Where was the narrator's own room for writing poetry located in the villa?

A: In a round tower.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "My Reminiscence" was written by:

- A. Kamala Markandaya
- B. Ernest Hemingway
- C. Toru Dutt

D. Rabindranath Tagore ✓

Explanation: Rabindranath Tagore. [medium, question-bank-2024]

2. Where was the narrator's brother living when the narrator returned home from his second trip to England?

- A. Kolkata
- B. London

C. Chandernagore ✓

D. Darjeeling

Explanation: Chandernagore. [medium, web-research]

3. How does the narrator originally describe the Ganges in this memoir?

A. Full of noise and activity

B. Cool and shaded along wooded banks ✓

C. Dry and barren

D. Flowing with industrial waste

Explanation: Cool and shaded along wooded banks. [medium, web-research]

4. What emotions does the narrator experience by the riverside?

A. Hunger and thirst

B. Fear and anxiety

C. Joy and longing ✓

D. Anger and frustration

Explanation: Joy and longing. [medium, web-research]

5. What has replaced the riverside nests described by the narrator?

- A. Schools
- B. Hospitals
- C. Parks
- D. Mills ✓**

Explanation: Mills. [easy, web-research]

6. What does the narrator refer to as 'dragon-like'?

- A. The mills ✓**
- B. The river
- C. The trees
- D. The sky

Explanation: The mills. [hard, web-research]

7. How does the narrator feel about the changes brought by modern industrial life?

- A. Entirely happy
- B. Indifferent
- C. Partly regretful ✓**
- D. Unaware of them

Explanation: Partly regretful. [medium, web-research]

8. How were the rooms in the riverside villa arranged?

- A. Regularly and on the same level
- B. In a straight line
- C. Irregularly and on different levels ✓**
- D. Circularly around a courtyard

Explanation: Irregularly and on different levels. [medium, web-research]

9. What kind of windows did the big sitting room have?

- A. Wooden shutters
- B. Frosted glass
- C. Clear glass without designs
- D. Stained glass with colored pictures ✓**

Explanation: Stained glass with colored pictures. [medium, web-research]

10. Where was the narrator's own room for writing poetry located in the villa?

- A. In a basement
- B. On the ground floor
- C. In the garden
- D. In a round tower ✓**

Explanation: In a round tower. [hard, web-research]